



Desktop of a freshly installed OpenSolaris system

- An open source development project.
- The community of users and developers who contribute to the project OpenSolaris.
- A free binary distribution.

Throughout this book, we'll be referring to the last meaning in the list, the term OpenSolaris means a free binary distribution of the OpenSolaris software that is available for redistribution under the terms of the Common Development and Distribution License (CDDL), unless otherwise stated.

1.2 Differences with Linux and Windows

Even though OpenSolaris is free and open source similar to Linux, it is different in many ways. Unlike the Linux distributions such as Ubuntu, Fedora and OpenSUSE, which are based on the Linux kernel, OpenSolaris is based on the Solaris kernel. This makes OpenSolaris fundamentally different from all the Linux based operating systems. But both OpenSolaris and Linux (and many other Unix like operating systems) are POSIX compliant (which is an industry standard for Unix based OS) and so thousands of applications which run on Linux based operating systems, also run on OpenSolaris.